

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #3317

Name

Miraflor Santos

Emailmiraflorista@gmail.com**Gender**

Female

City, state, and country of residence

Cambridge, MA, USA

Nationality

USA, Philippines

When did or will you finish your PhD?

sometime May - July 2025

University Education

PhD Biological Oceanography MIT-WHOI Joint Program (expected 2025)

B.S. Biology NYU Abu Dhabi 2019

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?

For most of my life I have been ocean illiterate - despite being descended from fish farmers and growing up near a premier oceanographic institution. When my family immigrated from the Philippines to the US, we were woefully uninformed. I didn't know that oceanography was a scientific field nor that phytoplankton are responsible for nearly half of global primary production and they play key roles in global biogeochemical cycles until I was a college junior. It wasn't until recently - in my final year of my PhD in oceanography - that I have come to deeply appreciate the benefits and privilege of being ocean literate. The ocean is not only deeply tied to the functioning of the planet but to our wellbeing. It doesn't just provide us with sustenance and

incomes, as it did for my ancestors, it can be the focal point of a personal identity and a national culture. So much is gatekept. There is still so much we don't know about the ocean. It is changing rapidly and under threat. I wish someone had explained this all to me so much earlier. I am applying to Science Corps because I would like to be that person for young kids today.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

UNESCO Youth Video Competition Winner - In college I spent a summer making a short film about education for sustainable development in the Peruvian Amazon. I got to screen it at the Paris Climate Conference in 2015. This experience taught me a lot about how to learn from and engage with local communities at the forefront of climate change.

UNFCCC Climate Change Youth Delegate - I was a student delegate for the United Arab Emirates at a UN climate change conference. I helped organize mock UN negotiations to explain the international climate change negotiation process.

One Ocean Week Youth Panelist - As a youth panelist for Bergen's One Ocean Week, I communicated the importance of ocean science and ocean literacy. I held discussions about climate justice and the structural inequalities that are hampering the ability of the most vulnerable to adapt to climate change.

Penikese Girls Youth Camp Instructor - I created a course for a girls science camp where we built these paper microscopes from Foldscope to analyze ocean specimens. With an interactive, curiosity-driven approach, I taught these girls how microscopes work so we could explore the microbial world.

Biology and Oceanography Tutor - I tutored high school students in biology, physics and oceanography.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Doing science in industry

Administrative role in industry or academia

In science education

In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

Near-term, I would like to finish my PhD and then pursue a 1-2 year policy fellowship either remotely or in Washington D.C. I am planning to apply for the fellowships that target STEM PhDs such as the Knauss Marine Policy Fellowship and the AAAS Fellowship.

Long-term, I imagine myself moving to the UK (because my partner lives there) and working at the interface of science and policy, potentially working in industry e.g. a carbon dioxide removal (CDR) technology startup, or working for a non-profit on science outreach, communication or advocacy. I am trying to be open to many long-term paths because my future job search is likely to already be constrained by location and the precarity of the job market. Regardless of my specific career path, I would very much like to continue helping others become ocean literate - particularly marginalized communities from the Philippines.

CV/Resume [Resume 2024 Sep.pdf](#)**How did you find out about Science Corps?**

Job board

Any other comments/questions?

Desired date of fellowship: July or August - December or January

Desired location: Philippines - I would be interested in volunteering at the existing Science Corps site in Jagna or potentially volunteering at a new site. I have a couple schools in mind and would be happy to foster new partnerships.

[Science Corps](#)